

▽ Bede BD-5J Microjet 1973

Origin USA

Engine 225 lb (102 kg) thrust Microturbo TRS-18 turbojet

Top speed 300 mph (500 km/h)

The Bede BD-5J Microjet is the world's smallest jet. During the 1970s and 1980s it was a popular airshow act, and also appeared in the James Bond film *Octopussy*. However, the type was a demanding machine to fly, and several were lost in accidents.



△ Pitts S-2A 1973

Origin USA

Engine 200 hp Lycoming AEIO-360 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 155 mph (249 km/h)

A two-seat version of the famous Pitts S-1 aerobatic biplane, the Pitts S-2A dominated the aerobatic scene in the 1970s. Even today, it is a fine aircraft with an excellent roll-rate, but it is inferior to the composite monoplane at top-level competitions.



△ Rutan VariEze 1976

Origin USA

Engine 200 hp Continental O-200 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 165 mph (266 km/h)

The VariEze is notable for making the canard design popular, and also for the extensive use of composites in the homebuilt market. It was fast and stall-resistant, although it does require a longer runway than conventional two-seaters.



△ Quickie Q2 1978

Origin USA

Engine 64 hp Revmaster 2100 (Volkswagen conversion) air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 140 mph (225 km/h)

The Quickie was originally designed as a single-seater by prolific aircraft designer Burt Rutan, and then evolved into the two-seat Q2. It had an unusual tandem-wing design, and was extremely fast for an aircraft with only 64 hp.



◁ Robin HR-200-120B 1976

Origin France

Engine 118 hp Lycoming O-235 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 110 mph (177 km/h)

With much better handling and a superior field of view than its American counterparts, the HR-200 is a fine basic trainer although it is interesting to note that—as with so many European light aircraft—it is powered by an American engine.

▷ Grumman American AA-5A Cheetah 1978

Origin USA

Engine 150 hp Lycoming O-320 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 149 mph (240 km/h)

Although never as popular as the four-seaters built by Cessna and Piper, the AA-5 series were generally faster and had better handling than either. Two interesting features were the sliding canopy (very unusual for a four-seater) and that the aircraft's skins were bonded and not riveted.



▷ Socata TB-9 Tampico 1979

Origin France

Engine 160 hp Lycoming O-360 air-cooled flat-4

Top speed 122 mph (196 km/h)

Built by French airframer Socata, the fixed-undercarriage TB-9 is the base model for the TB range. Built in the French city of Tarbes (hence TB) it is noticeably wider than many comparable four-seaters.

